

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

OUACHITA BAPTIST UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: November 18-19, 2024

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

OUACHITA BAPTIST UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL

Overall Performance Level		
MEETS		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

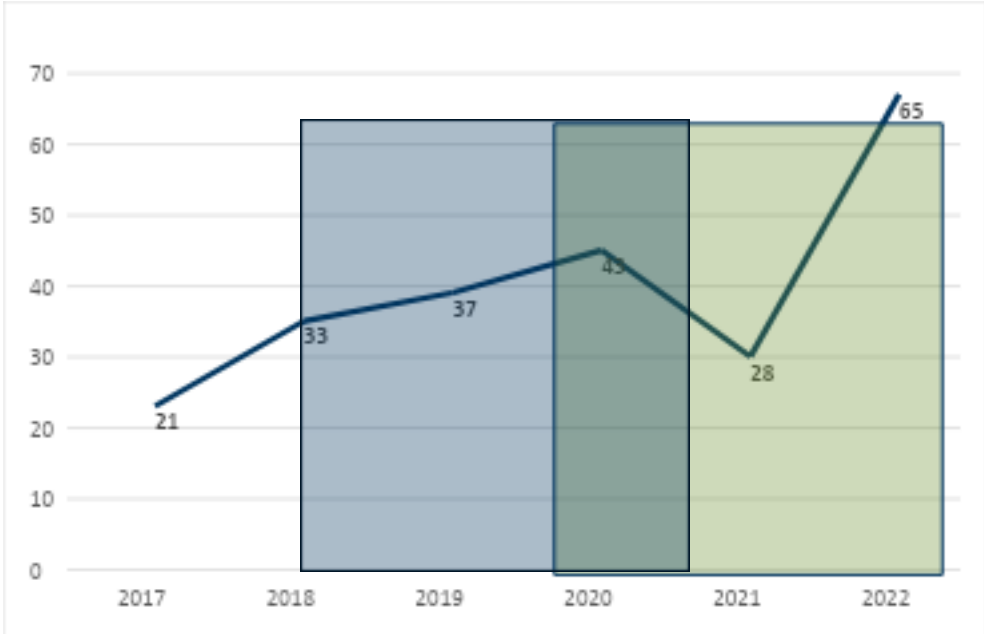
Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	APPROACHING	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
Recruiting additional candidates to increase overall enrollment, particularly in subject shortage areas, will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2a and 1.2b)</i>		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	OBU's Annual Plan is based on a proactive approach based on evidence and best practices.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	49.5%	EXCEEDS



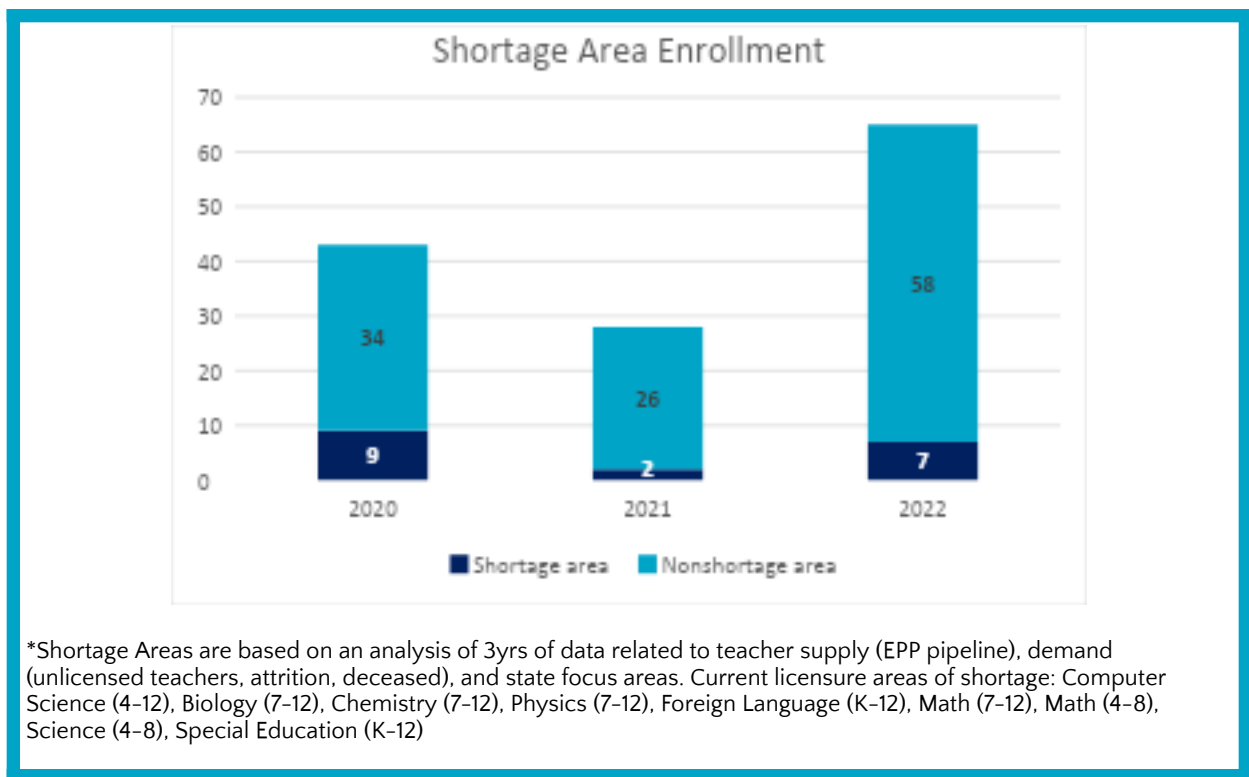
The line graph illustrates the percentage growth in 3-year average enrollment over a six-year period from 2017 to 2022. The vertical axis (y-axis) represents the percentage growth, ranging from 0 to 70 in increments of 10. The horizontal axis (x-axis) represents the years. The data points are as follows:

Year	Percentage Growth
2017	21
2018	33
2019	37
2020	45
2021	28
2022	65

The graph is visually segmented into three background regions: a blue region for 2018-2019, a green region for 2020, and a yellow region for 2021-2022. The line shows a general upward trend, with a notable dip in 2021 followed by a sharp increase in 2022.

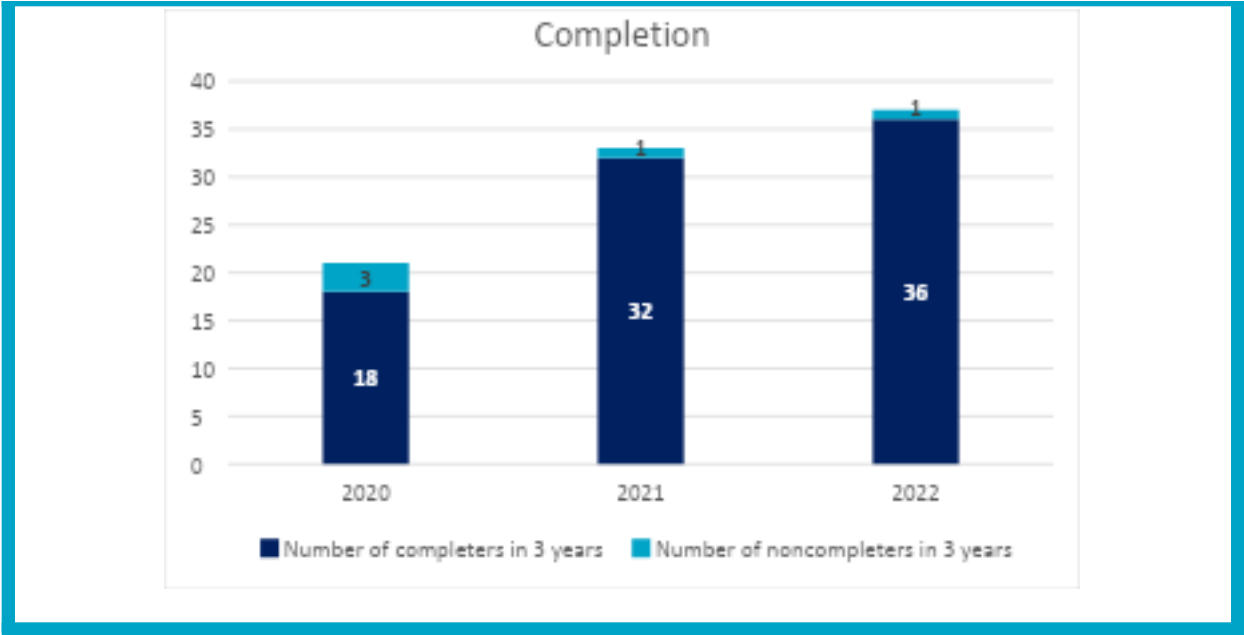
*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a “Meets” rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an “Exceeds” rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	13%	BELOW



INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	74%	95%	EXCEEDS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
Ouachita Baptist University has a strong education program preparing and supporting teacher candidates with multiple field experience opportunities, and effective instructors and clinical supervisors. Coursework is aligned, and candidates have opportunities to utilize HQIM. Candidates also have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their clinical supervisors and course instructors. OBU is well regarded by partner schools, and collaborative processes are in place with districts and schools to co-construct clinical experiences. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: - By 2026–2027, EPPs will need to provide evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training. - OBU should continue planning to meet the state’s one-year residency requirement, which will apply to spring 2027 completers and beyond.		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
MEETS
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction
MEETS
Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction, including recognizing and using high-quality instructional materials and evidence-based practices. OBU submitted a “Crosswalk Best Practices, HQIM, Aspiring Teacher Rubric” document that shows clear incorporation of best practices included in each course along with the Aspiring Teacher domains that are targeted. For example, in practicum courses for grades 4–8, 7–12, K–6, and for music, candidates must use at least three best practices in every lesson plan. Each week, candidates analyze a component from Domains 1–4, collect artifacts to demonstrate their understanding, and write reflections analyzing their strengths and areas for improvement. Multiple courses include the implementation and evaluation of HQIMs used in Arkadelphia including Eureka, Foundations, and Wit and Wisdom. Candidates are provided with coursework that ensures awareness of Science of Reading (SoR). The EPP developed a SoR Awareness level pathway involving the following required courses for middle school, secondary, and K–12 education majors: Child and Adolescent Development (EDFN 2053), Learning Theories and Assessment Practices (EDFN 4123), and Practicum Grades 4–8 (MSD 4523), Practicum Grades 7–12 (SCED 4523), and Practicum for Music (MUED 4301).

In the Coursework focus group, about half of the participants mentioned specific training in “Foundations” when asked about their familiarity with HQIM. One participant mentioned teaching a recent “Foundations” lesson and receiving support from her clinical supervisor in the pre-conference. During the Foundations of Education (EDFN 2003) course observation, the instructor used multiple engagement strategies throughout the lesson including callback procedure, paper and digital applications, movement around the room and appropriate pauses. The instructor also discussed HQIM in relation to objectives and lesson planning. Various HQIMs were in the classroom for candidates to use and incorporate into their Google slideshow assignment.

OBU submitted data used to measure current effectiveness from multiple groups of stakeholders and evidence of changes that were made to the coursework in response to the data collected. Although a specific example was provided, reviewers did not see evidence of the annual evaluation system itself.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally familiarizes candidates with Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area. Evidence provided demonstrates a clear progression of how candidates are exposed to information, and documentation demonstrates that their awareness and application increases by writing lesson plans, units of study and curriculum maps based on Arkansas Academic K-12 Standards. In their senior year, residents receive experience through the gradual release model to become active practitioners who use Arkansas K-12 standards for each lesson plan in their residency. The “Lesson Plan Examples and Rubric” document provided samples of lesson plans where candidates demonstrate their knowledge and incorporation of Arkansas K-12 standards.

Coursework clearly and intentionally provides candidates opportunities to vertically integrate standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area. The “EPP Coursework and Arkansas K-12 Standards” document contains a chart that describes where candidates become familiar with the Arkansas Academic K-12 Standards and when they design and develop plans that incorporate vertical integration. For example, in Reading: Children’s Literature (ELED 2033), candidates use grade level standards side-by-side to analyze and discuss the progression of the comprehension standards. In the Coursework focus group, nine out of ten teaching candidates gave specific examples of using standards in their lesson plans and in their coursework. They mentioned a course dedicated specifically to curriculum and planning where they learn to utilize essential standards and assessment in their content areas. One participant said they keep a copy of the standards in their binder so they can see vertical alignment and can utilize the range of grades to determine a student’s skill level in relation to standards. Candidates have experience teaching lessons aligned to standards to small groups and adjusting as needed to differentiate for a variety of needs.

During the observation of Foundations of Education (EDFN 2003), reviewers saw how the course provides opportunities for candidates to use the AR K-12 Standards within a grade level and how to vertically integrate using the standards. One teacher stated, “(we) cannot make a lesson plan if it’s not attached to a standard.”

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates’ coursework supports their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses

MEETS

Courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced across programs of study to build off previous coursework providing candidates an opportunity to show proficiency. Evidence provided included reinforcement opportunities for areas of growth and shows a progressive increase in rigor. There are four gates that document critical checkpoints throughout the program of study. Candidates are introduced to their program of study through the EPP Handbook and there is an eight-semester degree sheet for each content and licensure area as seen in the “2023-24_Teacher_Education_Handbook.pdf” (p. 25-61). Progression and reinforcement opportunities can be seen throughout the EPP’s sequence of courses in their professional education requirements and content major. The “AR Teaching Standard in Program” document provides a description of candidate’s requirements and culminating projects that build off previous coursework and increase in rigor.

In the coursework focus group, participants discussed the reading course progression, starting with foundational skills, progressing to reading and writing, and finishing with a reading diagnostics course. K-6 candidates explained how the

range of courses helps them understand the different reading levels of their students. Participants discussed the range of math courses, including number systems at the foundational level through algebra and geometry. They explained how this helps them meet the needs of a variety of students and prepares them to teach at the outer bands of their licensure areas. Secondary candidates discussed the mix of practical and technical training for areas like theater and kinesiology. In contrast, a math candidate discussed the range of her experiences in courses that helped her with an AP Statistics course. All candidates explained how courses were intentional and designed to help them understand their content as well as how to teach it.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in a way that develops candidates to meet the knowledge and skills of their required licensure area. The chart, "AR Educator Competencies," shows a matrix that includes each of the offered degrees. The "Arkansas Teaching Standard in Program" document shows how candidates' professional education requirements build from previous coursework and increase in rigor. It charts each AR Teaching Standard and indicates how it is addressed in each year of the program. The "EPP Crosswalk AR Teaching Standard with various measures" document provides evidence on how the EPP incorporates Arkansas Teaching Standards within the Aspiring Teacher Rubric/TESS, OBU lesson plan rubric, gate measures, and post-graduation measures.

In three out of four course observations, reviewers noted a clear and intentional connection to Arkansas Teaching Standards. In Foundations of Education (EDFN 2003), the lesson focused on Standard 4, content knowledge, and Standard 5, application of content. In Practicum (ELED 4043/MSED 4523/SCED 4523), reviewers observed a discussion around student surveys (which aligns with Standard 2 and Standard 3). Candidates created surveys for their students and spent time in small groups reflecting on their effectiveness. In Learning Theories and Assessments (EDFN 4123), Standards 1, 2, 5, 6, and 7 were observed. In the course, they discussed learner scores and where the scores fell relative to the standard. Candidates also discussed the conversations they would have with the parents of a student scoring at Level 1 at the end of the year compared to the conversations they would have with the parents of a student consistently scoring at Level 4. In the same course, the instructor provided assessment data from ATLAS and taught candidates how to read score reports and understand the performance levels.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience MEETS

The program provides three levels of field experiences with increasing complexity and participation. Field Experience in schools begins in the Introduction to Education (EDFN 1002) course with approximately five hours of observations during the semester. In the Foundations of Education (FN 2003) course, each candidate observes approximately 15 hours in classrooms in at least three developmental levels during the semester. Candidates process their observations through written reflections. As they continue through the program, teacher candidates will have other field experiences for example, Practicum in Elementary Education and Classroom Management (ECED 4043), Practicum in Education Grades 7-12 (SCED 4523) and Practicum in Education Grades 4-8 (MSED 4523). Each of the courses has 50 required hours of field experience. Candidates in these courses are assigned to a teacher for approximately five hours each week. Various small and large group teaching opportunities are provided throughout the experience. In addition to the opportunities described above, many courses have specific field experiences that are part of the curriculum. These range from one-on-one and small-group instruction to team-teaching with whole groups of students. Some classes include Family Night activities in the local schools while others assist with volunteer opportunities such as Special Olympics, as well as assist in community and church functions for children and youth. Clinical experiences require reflections, and feedback is provided using a rubric. An example of the "Foundations Reflections" document was included in the evidence submitted.

In the Coursework focus group, eight out of 10 candidates discussed alignment with field experiences from courses. There is a wide range of courses which cover lower and higher levels of content. One participant said "we need that because our students may need help below the level we teach; and the practicum class helps us feel prepared to teach different age levels and learning developmentally appropriate practices. We have exposure and experience in the field, teaching all levels and different subjects." Participants also shared that they have mock parent-teacher conferences, and sometimes utilize Google translate. They create practical resources they can use in their classrooms. In the Course Instructor focus group, most of the participants discussed reflections, utilizing peer feedback after presentations or lessons taught, and individual coaching on lessons. Some instructors also served in the role of university supervisors or advisors for students and were able to provide additional coaching and support.

In three course observations, reviewers saw evidence of alignment of coursework to clinical experiences. In Foundations of Education (EDFN 2003), candidates study the lesson planning template which they utilize in their clinical experience. Candidates talked about using the AR K-12 Standards in lesson plans and incorporating HQIM. In Practicum ELED 4043/MSED 4523/SCED 4523, candidates complete a weekly reflection based on their field experiences. In this reflection, candidates are directed to focus on components 2a and 2b of the Aspiring Teacher Rubric and give examples of seeing them in their own classroom experiences. In addition, candidates spent time discussing student surveys and their effectiveness. Finally, in Reading: Foundations (ELED 3093), teaching candidates provided evidence of previous learning and actions during the field components of the coursework. Candidates were able to review standards they had taught and discuss what they would expect to see in the next first-grade lesson. Candidates and the instructor discussed planning as it connected to the Arkansas SOR competencies.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K-12 Standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. The "Course Instructor List" shows that most course instructors have a terminal degree and hold an educator or administrator license. Most instructors have been trained in the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, and specific, recent professional learning is documented for all instructors. In the "First Year Completer Survey", question 8 asks, "To what degree did your education coursework and/or field experiences prepare you to demonstrate knowledge of content and pedagogy?" Thirteen of 16 respondents agreed or strongly agreed they were prepared. Reviewers noted evidence of instructors having deep knowledge of standards, content, and pedagogy in all four courses observed. Most participants in the Course Instructor focus group gave examples of using recent literature and articles in their classes with students to focus on latest evidence-based strategies, attending conferences to present and keep up with research, and being able to bring back information to implement in their own classes.

Course instructors develop an annual activity report and growth plan where they discuss ongoing professional development opportunities and experiences that allow them to remain up to date regarding content and pedagogy. The report and growth plan includes self-reflections on professional development, intellectual and creative contributions, university and community service, and an opportunity to identify areas of strength and growth. The growth areas include goals and a timeline to improve in these areas.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors have a proven history and show evidence of strong facilitation of coursework and providing feedback and support. Course instructors are evaluated annually, where they document a portfolio of activity and contributions to the program; their evaluation includes an annual growth plan. In the Coursework focus group, all participants agreed that their course instructors provided feedback and support. One participant stated, "We are becoming good teachers because of our good teachers and professors. They know us and have become part of our lives. They teach us well and make us feel capable, not only content-wise but how to deal with the emotional side of teaching and working with families." Another participant stated, "They don't just say here are the methods to use - they model it as they teach us." All candidates referred to the quality of their course instructors and their use of engaging methods to teach them, as well as their strong content knowledge. Several candidates mentioned personalized, handwritten feedback being given on every single assignment.

Reviewers saw evidence of this in all four course observations. Some of the examples provided by reviewers included course facilitation given through multiple modalities, including audio, paper, digital resources, and a video of the class for reference. Feedback was given on assignments and teacher candidates could resubmit assignments after making revisions based on feedback. In one specific example, the professor provided feedback as candidates answered questions and engaged in the lessons. When looking at ATLAS reports, one candidate acted out a conversation with parents and said, "Your child is basic." The instructor interrupted and reminded her that the child scored at a basic level, which is very different than saying a child is basic. The instructor continued to provide feedback as needed.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that

support their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. All candidates have multiple opportunities to observe in classrooms. Beginning in freshman and sophomore years, candidates are expected to complete 15-20 hours of observation. During their junior year, they observe and teach in their content area, and in their final year, candidates complete their residency. OBU is currently working to institute a year-long residency with at least two seven-to-eight-week placements in the candidate's content area. Elementary majors receive 131 hours in the field before student teaching, middle school majors receive 113 field hours before student teaching, and secondary majors receive 80-120 hours in the field before student teaching. In the documents submitted, reviewers saw a clear map of the different observations and the reflection opportunities provided for each program.

In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, all clinical supervisors discussed a gradual release strategy, from early field experiences to final experiences in student teaching. Candidates are also provided opportunities to have field experiences in multiple school locations across partner districts to see varied learning, diverse students, and field experiences. All Clinical Experience focus group participants discussed how their clinical experience is sequenced, agreed that there was a gradual release, and provided examples of clinical experiences they felt were intentionally planned and built upon previous experiences.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. Specific clinical experiences that enhance candidates' knowledge and skills include Teaching Students of Multilingual and Diverse Backgrounds, Teaching Exceptional Learners, Practicum, and Student Teaching. In the evidence provided, there is documentation that charts the percentage of students with IEPs and of English language learners.

Clinical Supervisor focus group participants shared that interns could work with students in various grade levels throughout their program and have opportunities to work with students with varied learning needs, including students with IEPs and with ELL students. All Clinical Experience focus group participants provided examples of their clinical experiences and the different opportunities they had. Similarly, most of the university supervisors gave examples of how candidates work with a variety of students at different grade levels and different learning needs.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Most experienced mentor teachers are equipped and demonstrate that they have the coaching skills to support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development. In the evaluation of clinical interns, candidates provide feedback on their EMTs. Most of the feedback is positive, and teacher candidates recommend their EMT to others. OBU has structures in place to support the effectiveness of their experienced mentor teachers. OBU schedules an initial meeting with experienced mentor teachers and candidates to provide introductions and campus tours and to discuss clinical internship requirements. They also host personalized training before and during the residency for mentor teachers and clinical supervisors. Training includes orientation and celebration meetings, as well as individualized conferences. EMTs are expected to conduct at least four performance assessments per semester using the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. At the launch of the yearlong residency, EMTs will also complete four additional walk-through observations.

All ten Clinical Experience focus group participants agreed that mentor teachers were equipped to support them by providing targeted coaching and pedagogical development. One participant provided specific examples of support and feedback she received, sharing that her mentor teacher helped establish classroom management procedures and provided feedback on transitions. Another participant shared an example of how their mentor teacher shared resources and artifacts to help her in the classroom. All Experienced Mentor Teacher focus group participants shared

that their feedback is aligned with the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, and most provided examples of support they gave to teacher candidates, including daily feedback and formal feedback twice per internship. EMTs discuss lessons before teaching and also give feedback after each lesson. One mentor teacher shared that not only do they provide new strategies to their candidates, but that they learn new strategies from them also.

Note: By 2026–2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

A clear and intentional process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers. School partners shared that all residents are placed with mentor teachers who have at least three years of experience, are licensed in the area of their candidate's placement, are TESS/Aspiring Teacher Rubric trained, have effective summative evaluations, will have had coaching training by Fall 2026, and are at a school that is not labeled "in academic distress" by DESE. Residents are matched with experienced mentor teachers who have similar personalities and philosophies to ensure effective mentoring, coaching, and feedback. The P-12 administration collaborates with the P-12 educators to ensure that they are able to fulfill the responsibilities of experienced mentor teachers.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors

MEETS

Most clinical supervisors have evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. There are clear requirements that clinical supervisors must meet to fill the role. For example, the Handbook states the following: "master's degree in education or related field is preferred, teaching license and at least three years of teaching experience are required, and strong leadership, communication, and interpersonal skills are expected". All clinical supervisors are working on becoming Aspiring Teacher trained and 100% will have completed the training by 2026. The EPP utilizes a yearly review process to evaluate effectiveness and survey results from teacher candidates indicate high satisfaction with clinical supervisors.

All Clinical Experience focus group participants agreed that their clinical supervisors are supportive and helpful. All Experienced Mentor Teacher focus group participants provided examples of their clinical supervisor coaching with a positive impact. One participant added, "The university supervisor [clinical supervisor] always communicates with me after an observation and always talks with me to ask if there are additional needs."

Four out of four Clinical Experience observation, reviewers saw evidence of clinical supervisors providing candidates with high quality feedback. Reviewers noted details such as "The clinical supervisor demonstrated positive feedback, guided by direct quotes and examples from the lesson. Additionally, the feedback was provided directly on the aspiring educator instrument." Reviewers also noted clinical supervisors are familiar with the K-12 Academic Standards, and feedback was based on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. In one observation, the review team noted, "the clinical supervisor shows evidence of high-quality coaching when pointing out that a misconception she didn't even consider during the pre-conference came up during the lesson and how that can be addressed in future lessons. This is evidence of coaching prior to the lesson and post lesson review as well to discuss instructional practices to address misconception and modeling how a teacher cannot always predict the misconception of students that will arise during the lesson."

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates

MEETS

Candidates consistently receive frequent, high-quality written and oral feedback from clinical supervisors that is aligned to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, clearly linked to evidence of student learning during observed lessons and informed by previous feedback. As stated in the narrative, "When the clinical supervisors begin their formal evaluations, they use the TESS/Aspiring Teacher Rubric during the POP cycle (pre-conference, observation, and post-conference) to assist candidates in addressing the targeted areas mentioned by the experienced mentor teacher. Intentional, high-quality feedback is given to candidates both oral and written during the post-conference for each of the components of the rubric. Coaching feedback is linked to previous feedback, the candidates and clinical supervisors discuss strengths for the candidates to continue to enhance and areas of improvements to focus on for the next observed lesson. Candidates are expected to provide evidence in the following POP cycle that the targeted areas have been analyzed and built on from the previous lesson." All Clinical Experience focus group participants were able to provide multiple examples of effective feedback from clinical supervisors. All four clinical experience observations reviewers noted the high quality of candidate feedback. One example includes a candidate receiving reflective feedback, primarily in coaching questions for self-reflection. There was an examination of growth from

previous lessons and plans for future instruction. In another example, the clinical supervisor cautioned the candidate against overusing “call and response” to be sure it doesn’t disrupt the lesson. The candidate received matching feedback during the conference and within the written documentation, all connected to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric.

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024–25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

EXCEEDS

Collaborative processes are in place with partner schools to co-construct the clinical experience. At OBU, there are two groups that are comprised of partner schools and EPP staff. The Teacher Education Advisory Council Board comprises area administrators and teachers at schools in which candidates are regularly placed for field experience and student teaching. This group helps facilitate communication and provides feedback on what is working and not working. The Teacher Education Council (TEC) includes representatives from all licensure areas. Meetings with these groups address a range of topics, including discussion of new initiatives and grants, the timing of EPP stakeholder surveys, the importance of using the TESS/Aspiring Teacher Rubric evaluation system to evaluate candidates, and transitioning to yearlong residency. It is also clear that there are communication structures in place. The Director of Student Teaching meets with all principals before residency and visits the partner school to meet mentor teachers after placement occurs. In the Partnership focus group, all seven partners agreed there is a strong partnership in place with the EPP. Some participants are part of an advisory group and in general, all felt there was open communication, the candidates are strong, and they can help develop the clinical internship experience.

The EPP utilizes a system for annual evaluation and continuous improvement to ensure partnerships are mutually beneficial to the EPP and partner districts. This system involves regular meetings with the EPP’s major partnerships in the Teacher Education Advisory Board and the Teacher Education Council. These stakeholders meet at least twice a semester to provide in-time communication, feedback, updates, and support. One example of the EPP’s continuous improvement, documented in recent “Teacher Education Advisory Board minutes,” was the opportunity to discuss transitioning to yearlong residency. The EPP’s partners were able to begin conversations regarding capacity building for experienced mentor teachers, the logistics of adding coaching training to teachers’ professional development hours and providing the EPP access or support to utilize HQIMs used in their school districts. After this meeting, one partner district registered seven teachers to complete the Lead Teacher Training.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes are consistently in place that support and develop effective clinical supervisors. There are opportunities for ongoing professional development through DESE and OBU’s partnership with Dawson Cooperative. Many members are part of the TEC and involved in ongoing conversations with partner schools about the program. During the 2023–2024 school year, several clinical supervisors participated in a PLC professional development offered by Solution Tree that connected OBU with local school districts to discuss literacy and mathematics. OBU plans to increase support for clinical supervisors working with candidates by continuing to host the “Called to Teach Conference” each July. The conference focuses on specific areas of growth, such as diversity, exceptionalities, technology, classroom management, differentiation, assessment, and collaboration with families. The EPP has also shared the virtual professional development training with their clinical supervisors to begin the process of receiving Aspiring Teacher Rubric training.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

The EPP maintains a quality assurance system consisting of multiple data sets to assess candidates’ performance in completion of coursework, clinical internship, meeting milestones, meeting expectations on the TESS/Aspiring

Teacher Rubric. The quality assurance system also monitors the level of support candidates receive when needed. Submitted evidence included the "Assessment Implementation Chart", which provides an of how the system tracks candidate progress and describes how OBU collects, analyzes, monitors, and reports data from multiple measures. The OBU Handbook outlines the four gateways to admission through completion that allows candidates to show proficiency in coursework. The average GPA for 2022-2023 completers was 3.547.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates who do not meet the criteria at each checkpoint complete reinforcement opportunities through an individualized support plan. Remediation plans are designed collaboratively by the Director of Student Teaching and the Director of Teacher Education. Candidates needing individualized support in Gate 2 are usually candidates who do not pass the Praxis II on their first attempt. These candidates are provided with several different options, including, 240 tutoring from Dawson Cooperative in preparation to retake the Praxis; postponing the residency and taking courses toward a minor until the Praxis II is passed; postponing the residency and re-enrolling in the university after passing the Praxis II; or removing education as a major. Individualized support plans are also created for candidates who do not successfully complete the Initial Portfolio Presentation/Interview. In this situation, candidates work with the Director of Student Teaching to create a plan involving counseling on the areas for improvement. These candidates complete a second Portfolio Presentation to demonstrate improvements.

In the Course Instructor focus group, multiple instructors alluded to the campus wide alert system to support struggling candidates. The alert system allows instructors to report a variety of academic or personal issues. The system is activated once an issue is registered, and instructors call, text and keep up with teacher candidates to ensure they are on track. The Academic Success Center provides tutoring and individual support sessions.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

The EPP has a set of clear and appropriate goals and milestones that align with overall program and state workforce needs. One of the requirements is to earn an effective rating on the final observation. One hundred percent of candidates completed the program from 2020 through the current semester, indicating that all candidates meet program goals and milestones

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

Candidates complete multiple items to measure impact on student growth, including the initial portfolio and interview, teacher work sample, and post portfolio interview. All candidates received a score of 90% or better, (the passing score is 75%) demonstrating strong analysis of student learning. The teacher work sample requires candidates to create a unit that incorporates a pre-assessment, teaches five lessons and includes a post assessment. Candidates then analyze student growth based on this project.

Clinical Experience focus group participants provided specific examples of their impact on student growth from their placements. One participant shared giving an exit ticket assessment at the end of a lesson and her experienced mentor teacher was excited to see the students were all "getting it!"

In all four Clinical Observations, reviewers cited examples of candidate's impact on student learning. In one Clinical Observation, the clinical supervisor talked about the ability to anticipate misconceptions after getting to know the students. In another, the clinical supervisor discussed the drawbacks of whole group assessments using magnetic tiles and suggested that next time candidates use more independent assessments to look for student growth. The clinical supervisor stated, "having an individual assessment helps figure out who may be struggling with this in comparison to who may not be struggling with that."

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

OBU provided evaluation data for each domain for their teacher candidates. On a scale of 1-3, with “3” being the highest and “2” being “acceptable,” teacher candidates averaged 2.87-2.9 on each domain their Spring 2024 Initial Portfolio assessment and 2.9-2.9 in their post portfolio project. On the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, Spring 2024 completers averaged 2.93 in their final evaluations.

Note: By 2024-25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

APPROACHING

Struggling candidates are sometimes provided with an individualized support plan if their development is not on track. OBU provided one example of a support plan where the teacher candidate requested a new placement. However, no other evidence was provided to detail what type of support is available to teacher candidates who struggle in their clinical internship. In a post observation during a clinical observation, the clinical supervisor and candidate discussed growth plans and determined that the candidate should focus on lesson timing. In another post conference, the clinical supervisor noted in the coaching session how this observation post conference is where they identify strengths and areas of growth to focus on in student teaching, but no growth plan was created. In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, participants shared that the mentor teacher often alerts them if additional support is needed, but no participant could give examples of formal support plans.

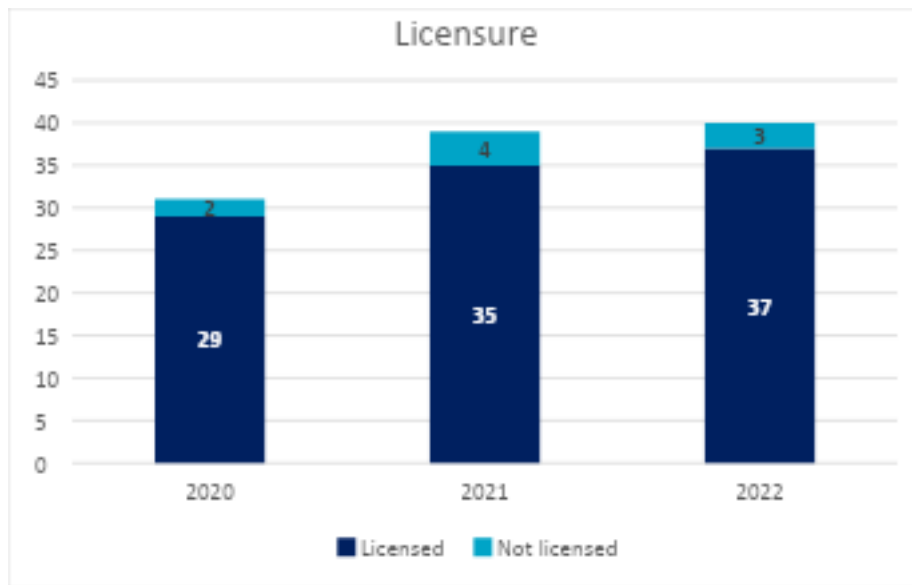
OBU has several organizations, scholarships, and leadership opportunities for high performing candidates, including becoming a member of Kappa Delta Pi, International Honors Society, and local OBU Chapter. High performing candidates may also receive one of several academic awards from the School of Education during the OBU Academic Awards Ceremony or may receive financial assistance to attend the Ron Clark Academy Training during their senior semester.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
EXCEEDS	BELOW	MEETS
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: 92% of completers earn their standard teaching license, however only 48% gain employment in Arkansas public schools within three years of program completion. Identify resources that support completers with finding jobs in public schools. (<i>Focus Area: Criteria 3.2a</i>) - A low proportion (27.5%) of completers are working in high-priority districts and subjects, pursue initiatives to encourage candidates to consider high-priority subject areas and work placements once licensed. (<i>Focus Area: Criteria 3.2b</i>)		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license	76%	92%	EXCEEDS

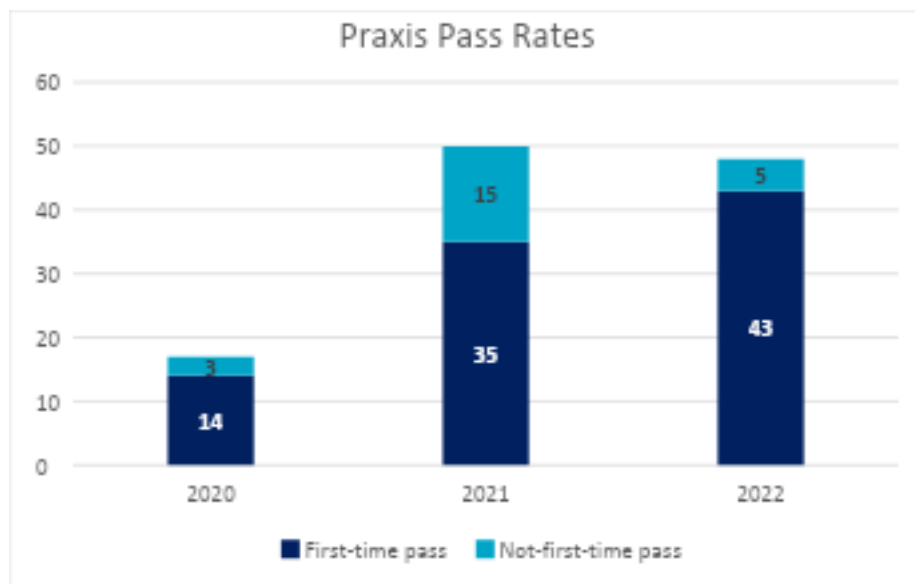


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	69%	n/a	n/a

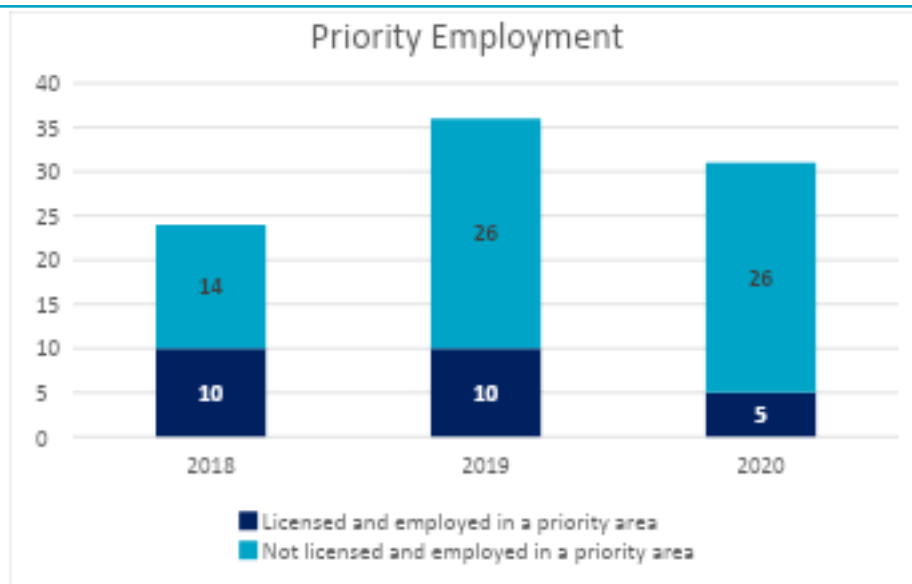
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	65%	80%	EXCEEDS



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	64%	48%	BELOW												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and employed</th><th>Not licensed and employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2018</td><td>15</td><td>9</td></tr><tr><td>2019</td><td>19</td><td>17</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>10</td><td>21</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed	2018	15	9	2019	19	17	2020	10	21
Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed													
2018	15	9													
2019	19	17													
2020	10	21													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	40%	27.5%	BELOW												



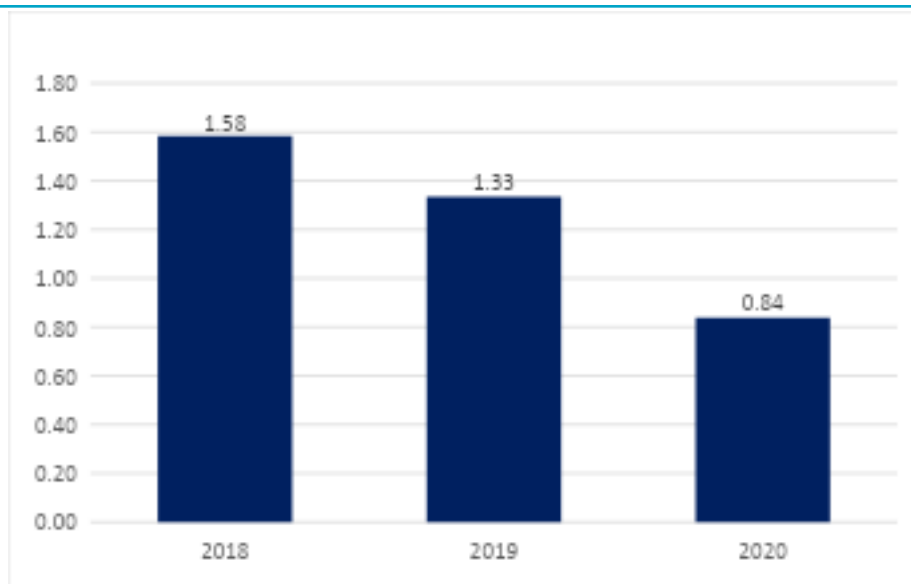
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

Current subject shortage areas for employment: Computer Science, Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.7	1.23	MEETS



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	81%	75%	APPROACHING
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	75%	90%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	64%	EXCEEDS

Value-Added Growth Scores

